

SEBASTIAN GROSSBERGER VILLARROEL

Senior Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET) | Manual & Test Automation | API & Database Testing

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linkedin.com/in/sebastian-grossberger • [Portfolio](#) • 100% Remote — U.S. Central / Eastern Time Zones • Independent Contractor

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET) with 6+ years across manual testing and test automation, combining hands-on exploratory and end-to-end testing with production-level automation framework development. Proven track record designing complete testing strategies grounded in the Test Pyramid and Agile Testing Quadrants, building **Playwright, Cypress, and Selenium** frameworks with **Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, and Java/C#**, validating **REST APIs** with Postman/Newman, and performing advanced **SQL Server / relational database** testing against complex schemas. Experienced embedding automated tests into **CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, GitHub Actions)**, driving root cause analysis on live SaaS platforms, and conducting performance testing with JMeter. Fluent in advanced English, currently teaching QA and automation at Universidad Fidélitas, and available full-time across U.S. time zones.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Test Automation: Playwright (framework owner), Cypress, Selenium WebDriver, Page Object Model, end-to-end frameworks, SOLID principles, clean-code standards, parallel cross-browser execution

Programming & Scripting: Python (advanced), JavaScript / TypeScript (advanced), Java / C# (OOP automation), SQL (advanced)

Manual Testing: Functional, Regression, Smoke, Exploratory, End-to-End, UAT, Risk-based, Cross-browser / Cross-device

API & Backend Testing: REST API testing, Postman, Newman, SOAP / SoapUI, JSON / XML validation, contract testing, batch & big-data testing

Databases: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Oracle (relational schemas), MongoDB / NoSQL, joins, subqueries, window functions, ETL validation

CI/CD & DevOps: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, TeamCity (familiar), quality gates, deployment & release validation, continuous delivery

Performance Testing: JMeter (load, stress, response-time analysis), BlazeMeter / Taurus concepts

Async & Distributed: Kafka event streams (producer/consumer validation), asynchronous workflow validation

Production Support: Incident triage, root cause analysis (RCA), SLA management, Chrome DevTools, Datadog (logs & monitoring)

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Shift-Left Testing, TDD, BDD/ATDD, Test Pyramid, Agile Testing Quadrants

Defect & Test Mgmt: Jira, Zephyr Scale, TestRail, Confluence, Salesforce (CRM) integration testing

Languages: English (advanced / professional working proficiency), Spanish (native)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior QA / SDET Engineer

Oct 2024 – Present

Nitel · San José, Costa Rica (Remote, U.S. time zones)

- Designed and maintained **150+ automated test cases in Playwright and Cypress** for critical-path regression and release validation, building reusable page objects and framework conventions that the squad could extend.
- Architected an **end-to-end automated test suite for Salesforce-integrated workflows** (custom objects, workflow rules, cross-system data integrity), cutting manual regression effort by ~65% and freeing the team for exploratory testing.
- Diagnose, triage, and resolve **production issues** on a live SaaS platform under SLA, performing root cause analysis across the UI, REST API, and data layers.
- Validate **REST APIs with Postman** — request/response payloads, status codes, authentication, and edge cases — and run advanced **SQL** queries (joins, subqueries, aggregations) for backend data validation against production-like schemas.
- Investigate frontend and network defects with **Chrome DevTools** and monitor system health in **Datadog**; document defects in **Jira** with reproduction steps, logs, network traces, and business-impact analysis.
- Collaborate daily in **Agile/Scrum** ceremonies with Engineering, Product, and Client Support across PST/MST/CST/EST, contributing to test scenarios, acceptance criteria, and release validation.

QA Engineer / QA Squad Lead

2020 – Sep 2024

The Lifetime Value Company (LTV) · San José, Costa Rica

- Owned the **migration of a fragile legacy Selenium suite to a modern Playwright/Cypress framework** with parallel execution across 5 browsers, reducing suite runtime from 45 to 27 minutes and standardizing page objects, conventions, and reporting.
- Designed **automated quality gates in Jenkins and GitHub Actions** — blocking PRs on lint, unit, integration, and regression failures with rollback on deploy-time failures — contributing to **zero critical production incidents over 6 months**.
- **Led two QA squads (Email & Flow)** on a high-traffic consumer SaaS platform; mentored two junior engineers into leadership roles and improved testing efficiency by 30%.
- Performed functional, regression, smoke, and **exploratory testing** across web and mobile; validated **REST API** endpoints with Postman (reusable collections, environment variables) and wrote advanced **SQL** (joins, subqueries, window functions) to verify ETL outputs.
- Validated **asynchronous workflows** — Kafka event streams and MongoDB collections — for data consistency across distributed services, and conducted **performance testing with JMeter** to identify bottlenecks under load.
- Standardized defect reporting in **Jira** (severity vs. priority templates), reducing defect resolution time by 30%; performed WCAG accessibility checks with Lighthouse and axe.

University Professor — Software QA & Test Automation

Jan 2023 – Present

Universidad Fidélitas · San José, Costa Rica

- Teach undergraduate courses on **QA methodologies, SDLC, Agile/Scrum, manual testing, and test automation** with Python and Selenium, translating real-world engineering practice into curriculum.
- Designed hands-on workshops on test case design, defect reporting standards, **API testing with Postman**, BDD/TDD, and accessibility fundamentals.
- Mentored **400+ students** through 1:1 sessions and code reviews, achieving a 90% job-placement rate among active program participants.

QA Analyst (Apprentice)

2019 – 2020

Pernix · San José, Costa Rica

- Executed manual regression, functional, responsive, and performance testing, reaching 80% coverage on assigned modules.
- Built initial automation scripts in **Selenium / Python**, reducing manual execution time by 50%, and authored detailed test cases and defect reports with clear reproduction steps and evidence.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Bachelor of IT Management** — Tecnológico de Costa Rica (TEC)
- **Scrum Foundation Professional Certificate (SFPC™)** — Certiprof, 2024
- **Cybersecurity Awareness Professional Certificate (CAPC)** — Certiprof, 2024
- **Salesforce Trailhead** — 33+ badges (Security, Marketing Cloud, Platform Fundamentals)